Information For the Use of
Acitretin (25mg) Capsule

Asretin 25 Capsules

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Acitretin 25 mg Capsules

1. Composition

Each capsule contains:

Acitretin — 25 mg
Excipients — q.s.

2. Pharmacological Action

Acitretin is an oral retinoid related to vitamin A. It regulates skin-cell growth and differentiation and helps reduce abnormal keratinisation, scaling and thickening of the skin.

3. Indications

Acitretin is used under specialist supervision for severe disorders of keratinisation, including:

- Severe psoriasis, including selected pustular or erythrodermic forms
- Severe ichthyosis and other disorders of keratinisation, where indicated

Treatment should be initiated and monitored by a dermatologist.

4. Dosage and Administration

Take orally exactly as prescribed by the treating dermatologist. Dosage is individualised according to the condition, response and tolerability.

- Take with food, as directed by the product information.
- Do not change the dose or discontinue treatment without medical advice.
- Regular clinical and laboratory monitoring is required.

5. Precautions

- **Highly teratogenic:** Acitretin can cause severe birth defects.
- Patients who can become pregnant must follow the applicable pregnancy-prevention programme and contraception requirements before, during and after treatment. Pregnancy must be avoided for **at least 3 years after stopping acitretin**.

- Do not donate blood during treatment or for 3 years after discontinuation.
- Monitor liver function and blood lipids before and during treatment.
- Avoid vitamin A supplements and other retinoids unless specifically directed by a specialist.
- Limit alcohol and follow the prescriber's advice, because alcohol may promote formation of etretinate, which persists for a long time in the body.
- Use cautiously in patients with diabetes, obesity, lipid disorders or liver disease.

6. Contraindications

Acitretin is contraindicated in:

- Pregnancy and breastfeeding
- Patients who can become pregnant unless all required pregnancy-prevention conditions are met
- Severe hepatic or renal impairment
- Chronic abnormally elevated blood lipids
- Hypersensitivity to acitretin or other retinoids
- Concomitant use of methotrexate, tetracyclines or vitamin A/other systemic retinoids, as specified in the approved prescribing information

7. Adverse Reactions

Common adverse effects may include:

- Dry lips, dry skin and peeling
- Dry eyes and irritation
- Dryness of the nose and nosebleeds
- Hair thinning
- Muscle, joint or back discomfort
- Increased liver enzymes or blood lipid levels

Seek prompt medical attention for severe headache or visual changes, severe abdominal pain, jaundice, marked mood changes or other serious symptoms.

8. Drug Interactions

Important interactions include:

- **Methotrexate:** increased risk of liver toxicity
- **Tetracycline antibiotics:** increased risk of raised intracranial pressure
- **Vitamin A supplements and other retinoids:** increased risk of retinoid toxicity
- **Alcohol:** may contribute to formation of long-lasting etretinate
- **Phenytoin:** acitretin may affect phenytoin protein binding

Review all medicines and supplements with the treating specialist.

9. Pregnancy and Lactation

Acitretin must not be used during pregnancy or breastfeeding. Pregnancy must be avoided during treatment and for at least 3 years after stopping treatment. Patients who can become pregnant must comply with the complete locally applicable pregnancy-prevention requirements and testing schedule.

10. Storage

Store as directed on the approved product label, protected from excessive heat, moisture and light. Keep out of reach of children.

11. Note

Prescription medicine for specialist use. Dispense and use only in accordance with applicable regulations and the approved prescribing information.

Important: This is a draft product-literature template, not an official approved package insert. Verify all warnings, contraindications, monitoring requirements and pregnancy-prevention wording against the current approved Indian prescribing information before printing or distribution.

Manufactured in India for:

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